



What Your Business can Learn from Twitch



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Twitch has made its way out of the sports niche into a mainstream interactive live-streaming platform. The community centered platform has attracted users from music fans to television watchers with TV Nights featuring color commentary. Launched in 2011 as Justin.TV, Twitch has grown into a media force acquired by Amazon in 2014. Today Twitch has more than 100 Million unique monthly users and 2.2 million monthly broadcasters. This begs the questions, how did a platform adapted by gamers expand into the second largest streaming service without losing their audience and what can your business learn from Twitch.

Lesson One: Listen to feedback and evolve.

Twitch, as it was formerly known, Justin.tv started out as a vlogging site but it didn't take off right away. The reviews were mixed, and the concept of a Big Brother Reality Show was not catching on. People weren't too interested in their daily lives but were

more interested in how to stream their own content. Instead of pushing their original idea, Justin.tv pivoted to letting users stream and it was widely adopted by gamers, thus Twitch was born. They leaned into the early adopters and became a videogame streaming service.

Lesson Two: Speed does not always mean success.

Following their success in the pivot to gaming, Twitch continued to listen to their consumers and come up with effective & innovative solutions. Rapid deployment may make your team happy but if you don't take the time to account for the consumer the product is not going to succeed. Working from a place of empathy makes for strong partnerships and client relationships.

Lesson Three: Keep Core Values.

Twitch is founded on content created by users and they have not let their ownership by Amazon or sponsored partnerships affect their core model. All content is delivered live, interactive and from a creator-focused approach. Twitch is always transparent, and the community engagement is still authentic. They work with brands like Old Spice and PepsiCo to make sure their campaigns reflect the Twitch values. Old spice's nature adventure was fully user driven by having actions dictated with Twitch Chat.

Lesson Four: Foster Organic Growth.

The expansion to music, sports, and other areas is booming and averages more viewers than some cable networks. The way this expansion took hold was by employing the three prior lessons, listening to the audience, not rushing product and keeping to the core values. Twitch never attempted to push the new media onto their loyal fanbase instead they leveraged user feedback and strategically offered content. Non-gaming brands are premiered based on community interest and continues to expand. Their content partnerships are always strategic, user-centric and authentic.

Will you be using any of these tactics? Have you used Twitch in your marketing? Share below

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